

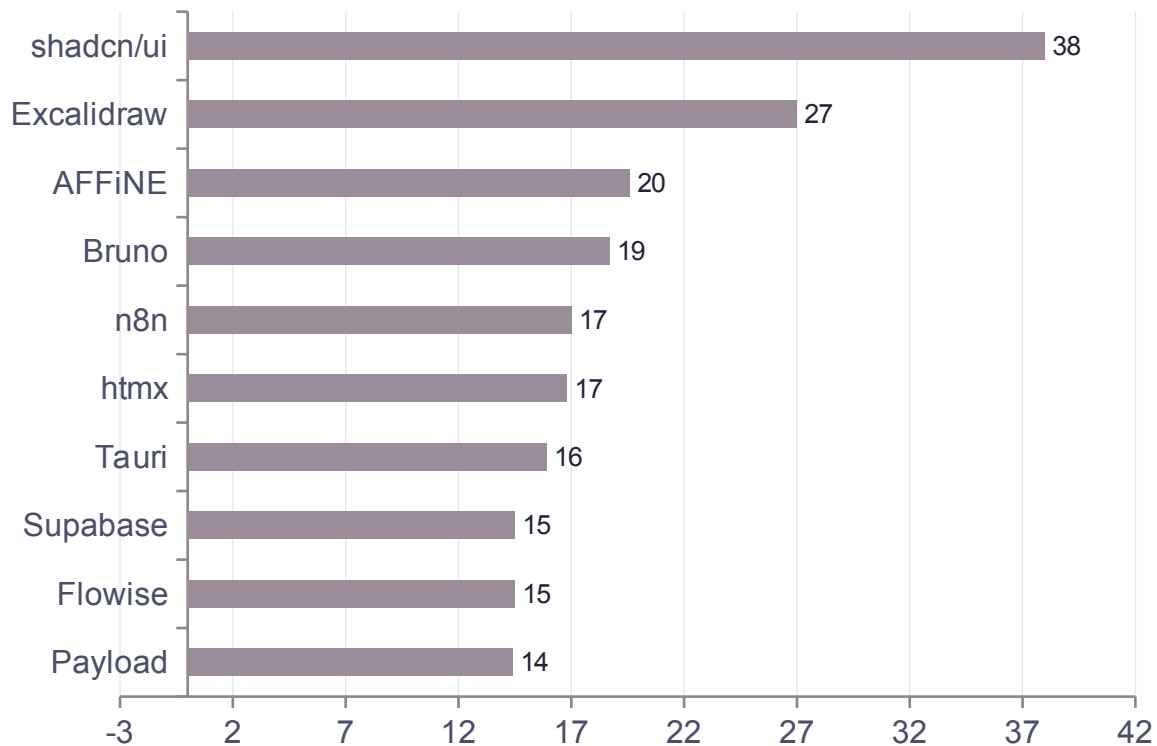
2024 JavaScript Rising Stars: The Year's Hottest Projects by GitHub Stars

9th Edition · GitHub Stars Added in 2024 · Curated by Best of JS

A data-driven overview of the most-starred JavaScript projects in 2024, highlighting the dominance of shadcn/ui, the rise of htmx, and major framework evolutions.

Frontend Engineers & Engineering
Managers

shadcn/ui Leads Overall with +38k Stars, Followed by Excalidraw and AFFiNE



+38.0k

shadcn/ui stars added — 41% more than #2

+27.0k

Excalidraw — virtual whiteboard for hand-drawn diagrams

Methodology

Stars added over the last 12 months for projects curated by Best of JS.

shadcn/ui: Copy-Paste Components Win for the Second Consecutive Year

77.5k total stars

Created Jan 2023 · 39.5k in 2023 · 38.0k in 2024

January 2024 peak: 7.3k stars in a single month

Key 2024 Additions

- Charts — powered by Recharts
- Themes — CSS variable generation
- Blocks — layout collections for typical web apps
- Responsive sidebar component
- Upgraded CLI — Next.js, Remix, Vite, Laravel, monorepos
- Registry ecosystem — Motion-Primitives, Magic UI

Vercel v0 Integration

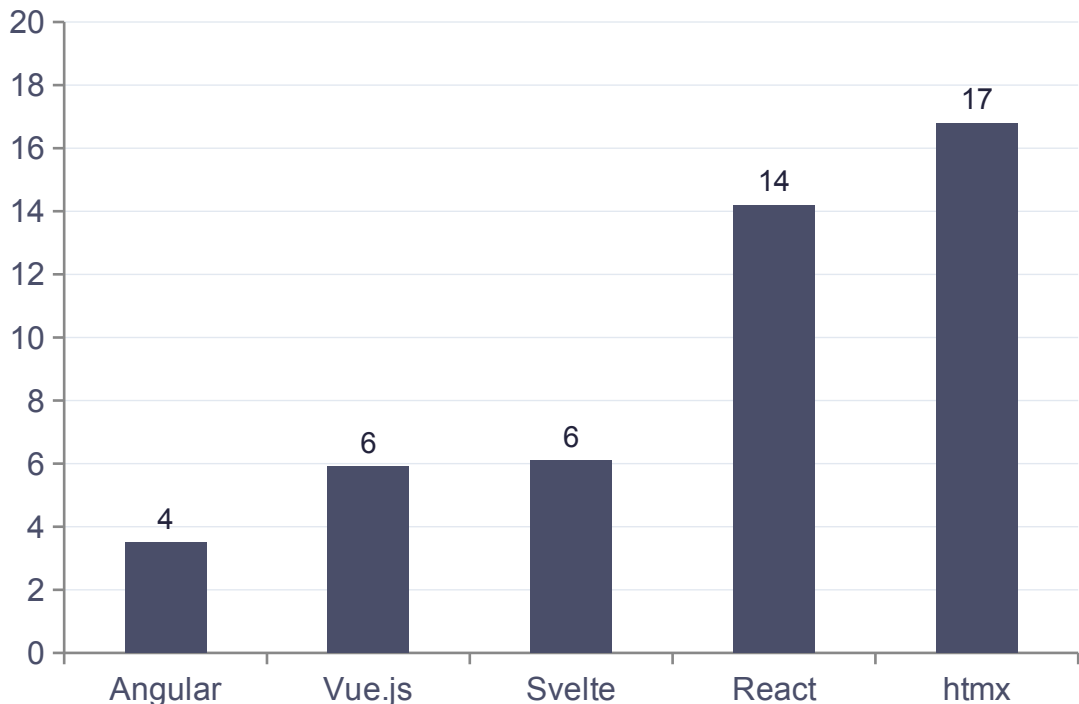
AI-generated components via Vercel's v0 service further boosted adoption, making shadcn/ui a default starting point for modern UI.

Ecosystem Effect

The CLI can install components, themes, hooks, utils, and dependencies from any compatible registry. This spawned derivative libraries and cemented shadcn/ui as a platform, not just a component set.

Source: risingstars.js.org/2024/en

htmx Overtakes React as #1 Front-end Framework by Stars Added



htmx #1

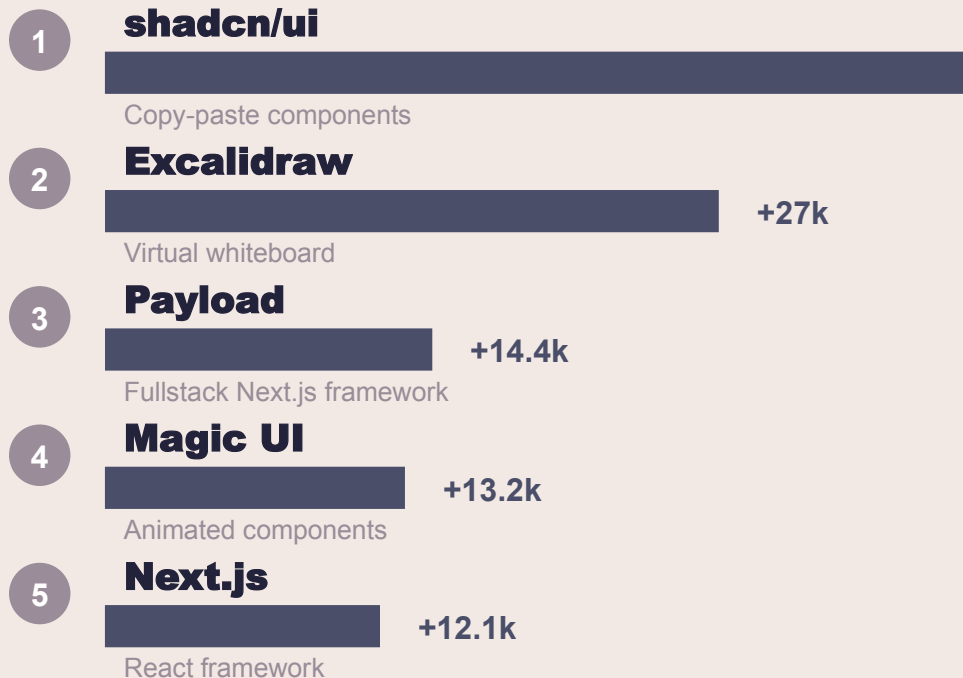
Rose from #2 in 2023. Extends HTML with hx-* attributes for AJAX and WebSockets — no JavaScript required. Ideal for server-driven apps and progressive enhancement.

React 19

Launched Dec 2024 after 3 years. Server Components, Server Functions, Custom Elements support, new hooks, form actions. React is evolving from a library into a framework specification.

Svelte 5 introduced 'runes' for explicit reactive state. Highest positive opinion in State of JS survey.

React Ecosystem: shadcn/ui, Excalidraw, and Payload Dominate



React as a Specification

With server components and Server Functions in React 19, multiple frameworks (Next.js, Remix, etc.) now interpret React's primitives differently. Robin Wieruch notes React is becoming 'a specification for frameworks' — a framework-first mindset while still allowing client-only usage.

React Compiler continues development to improve performance and DX, signaling long-term investment in developer experience.

Source: risingstars.js.org/2024/en

Vue Ecosystem Flourishes: Nuxt, PrimeVue, and Slidev Lead Growth

Nuxt

+6.2k

stars

The intuitive Vue framework

PrimeVue

+5.4k

stars

UI component library

Slidev

+4.7k

stars

Presentation slides for devs

shadcn-vue

+4.1k

stars

Vue port of shadcn/ui

VitePress

+3.7k

stars

Static site generator

Vue 3.5 & Ecosystem Momentum

- Vue 3.5 reworked its reactivity system with the lighter alien-signals approach already landing in the main branch.
- A wave of high-quality UI libraries (PrimeVue, shadcn-vue) signals growing ecosystem confidence.
- Daniel Roe (Nuxt core team lead) highlighted the active release cycle and regular performance improvements.

Source: risingstars.js.org/2024/en

AI Tools, Desktop Apps, and Browser-Based Innovation Shape 2024

AI-Powered Tools	Desktop & Mobile	Browser Innovation
• n8n — +17.0k · workflow automation with native AI • Flowise — +14.5k · drag & drop LLM flows • Supabase — +14.5k · open-source Firebase alternative with AI integrations • AFFiNE — +19.6k · knowledge base with AI features	• Tauri — +15.9k · lighter desktop/mobile apps built with web tech • Replaces Electron for smaller bundle sizes • Growing adoption for cross-platform tooling	• PGLite — Postgres via WebAssembly in the browser • WebVM — a full virtual machine running entirely in the browser • Pushing the edge of what's possible client-side

Cross-cutting insight: Four of the top 10 overall projects have significant AI capabilities or integrations. AI is no longer a niche — it's table stakes for developer tools.

Source: risingstars.js.org/2024/en

Key Takeaways: What 2024 Tells Us About JavaScript's Future

01 Component ownership beats imports

shadcn/ui's model of letting developers own and customize component code proved its staying power for a second year, reaching 77.5k total stars.

02 HTML-first is serious

htmx overtook React as the #1 front-end framework by stars added, validating server-driven, low-JavaScript architectures.

03 React is becoming a framework spec

With Server Components and Server Functions in React 19, multiple frameworks now interpret React's primitives differently.

04 AI integration is table stakes

Four of the top 10 overall projects (n8n, Flowise, Supabase, AFFiNE) have significant AI capabilities or integrations.

05 Vue's ecosystem maturity

A wave of high-quality UI libraries and the Vue 3.5 reactivity overhaul signal a confident, maturing Vue ecosystem.

Heading into 2025: expect AI-native tooling, server-driven UI patterns, and mature component ecosystems to define the next wave of JavaScript innovation.